A-A-20044
November 16, 1984

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BUTTER

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description by all Federal agencies in preference to Federal Specification C-B-801.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers butter suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

A. Types, grades, and styles.

The product shall be packed and packaged in commercially acceptable containers except when specified by the contract or purchase order. The contract or purchase order shall specify the type, grade, and style of product desired.

Types.

Type I - Salted
Type II - Unsalted

Grades.

U.S. Grade AA
U.S. Grade A

Styles.

Style 1 - Bulk
Style 2 - One-pound print solids
Style 3 - One-quarter pound prints, four prints per carton
Style 4 - Individual servings (90 servings per pound unless otherwise specified)

a - Prescored slabs
b - Free standing serving
c - Wrapped
d - Sealed container

B. Finished product description.

Types I and II.

Style 1 - Butter which is commercially packed in bulk is available in a variety of sizes. These sizes range from 10 to 68 pounds per container with 68 pounds per box being predominant.

FSC 8910

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Style 2 - Butter which is produced in one-pound prints is packaged in several commercially-available case sizes which range from 12 to 36 pounds per case.

Style 3 - Butter which is produced in 1/4-pound prints is usually packaged in four 1/4-pound prints per carton. The case sizes range from 12 to 36 pounds per case.

Style 4 - Butter which is produced in individual size servings is available in a variety of packaging styles and serving sizes. The serving size, depending on the style requested, may be 47, 60, 72, 90, or 108 servings per pound. The packaging styles fall into four general areas.

a. Prescored slabs - Butter which is packaged in this style is simply a narrow slab of butter which has been prescored to facilitate portion control. The individual servings are broken off from the slab and served.

b. Free standing serving - Butter which is packaged as free standing servings is separated within the carton by a light weight cardboard on one side and a piece of parchment on the other side of the butter serving.

c. Wrapped - Butter is also available in individually wrapped servings. These wrappers completely enclose the butter and may be made of foil, foil-laminate, or paper.

d. Sealed container - Individual servings of butter are also available in sealed containers. These containers are usually a plastic cup which contains a portion of butter. The top of the cup is sealed to the container.

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specific salient characteristics of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with the Federal Definition of Butter, Public Law 519 of the 67th Congress as well as all applicable Federal and State

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mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. The delivered product shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

The butter shall be manufactured in a plant approved by the Dairy Grading Section, Dairy Grading and Standardization Branch, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA), prior to submission of offer. Approved plants must satisfactorily meet the requirements contained in the General Specifications for Approved Dairy Plants and Standards for Grades of Dairy Products. The product shall be examined and tested in accordance with the applicable United States Standards for Grades of Butter. When requested in the contract or purchase order, the containers shall be examined in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of solicitation, and in accordance with the requirements in the applicable regulations.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The butter shall be preserved, packaged, packed, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the contract or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

Notes.

Purchasers shall specify:

- The type, grade, and style of product desired.

- The pack and packaging size.

Purchasers may specify:

- Labeling requirements if different from normal commercial practice.

- Container sizes and requirements if butter is to be packaged in metal containers.

- If USDA is to perform a Condition of Food Containers inspection.

- Product characteristics which may differ from commercial characteristics but do not affect U.S. Grade (such as percent fat and moisture).

- If the butter is to be delivered frozen.

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- Age of the product upon shipment.

- If butter shall be subject to a seven-day, 72°F (22°C), keeping quality test.

Sources of documents:

Sources of nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
1616 P Street, NW
Washington, DC 20036

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Sources of governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. This three-volume set may be purchased from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

Civil agencies and others may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specification Unit (WFSIS)
Room 6039
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407
Telephone: (202) 472-2205

Copies of the General Specifications for Approved Dairy Plants and Standards for Grades of Dairy Products and the U.S. Standards for Grades of Butter may be obtained from:

Dairy Standardization Section
Dairy Division, Room 2750-S
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Washington, DC 20250

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Copies of the U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers may be obtained from:

Director
Market Research and Development Division
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Washington, DC 20250

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID may be submitted to:

Director
Market Research and Development Division
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Washington, DC 20250

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - MRD
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - DA

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